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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trade battle with China intensifies



President Donald Trump speaks during a White House meeting Thursday. **POOL**

US markets resume slide as Trump hikes tariff on Asian nation

By Josh Boak
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — In the aftermath of this week's tariff whiplash, President Donald Trump is now tasked with deciding exactly what he wants out of trade talks with as many as 75 nations in the coming weeks.

Trump is also figuring out next steps with China. He upped his tariffs on Chinese goods to 145% after China placed retaliatory taxes of 84% on imports from the U.S. While his 90-day pause on other tariffs caused the stock market

to rally on Wednesday, countries still face a baseline 10% import tax instead of the higher rates announced on April 2.

But even the rebound in U.S. financial markets was brief, as stocks dove Thursday, surrendering a chunk of their historic gains from the day before, indicating that Trump's trade war continues to confuse and threaten the economy, even if its temperature has cooled a bit.

The S&P 500 was down 3.5% Thursday, slicing into Wednesday's surge of 9.5%. The Dow Jones Industrial Average was down 2.5%,

and the Nasdaq composite was 4.3% lower.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said any trade agreements will be "bespoke" deals, rather than some overarching pact among a group of countries. Trump has laid out a series of grievances and goals regarding tariffs, but Canadian and European counterparts have said the actual demands from administration officials have been vague so far.

Trump has said he wants to eliminate the \$1.2 trillion trade deficit, which means he no longer wants the U.S. to import more

goods than it exports to other nations. He also wants revenues from tariffs to offset his income tax cut plans. The president has also said he wants the tariffs to bring back factory jobs and raise workers' wages.

Aides have said that Trump wants other nations to scrap regulations and other policies such as Europe's value-added taxes that he deems to be a barrier to U.S. goods, an ask that would require other countries to change their laws. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick has said the goal is to get other nations to "respect" Trump.

The Budget Lab at Yale Univer-

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UIC grad scrambles after visa is revoked

Former student was working in US, turns focus to self-deporting

By Carolyn Stein
Chicago Tribune

It was a typical Thursday night for the financial analyst, who was watching "Lord of the Rings" when he got the email with the subject line "visa revoked." At first, the University of Illinois Chicago grad from India thought it was a joke — just a scam email from some Indian website trying to mess with him.

But then he received a second email after he tried logging into his Student and Exchange Visitor Program portal. "Your OPT authorization period has ended," the email read.

At that moment, his entire life paused. The former student, who asked to remain anonymous for fear of retribution, graduated from UIC in 2023 and was continuing to work in the U.S. on a STEM optional practical training extension. He previously worked at Bank of America and was being considered for a role at J.P. Morgan.

Now, he has to focus on self-deporting, selling off items like his TV and giving away other belongings to his friends. He plans on leaving the country April 13 and is unsure whether he'll even be able to work for J.P. Morgan.

"I would choose to stay and fight but on Reddit I've been hearing different stories about ICE detaining students," the former student said.

He is one of hundreds of international students nationwide who have had their visas terminated in the past few weeks for unclear or arbitrary reasons.

At the University of Wisconsin-Madison, a student one month away from graduating seemingly had her visa revoked for a previous traffic violation. In Florida, a student from Colombia was taken into custody by immigration agents after he was stopped by Gainesville police with an expired registration and driver's license. He signed his self-deportation and returned home.

In Illinois alone, dozens of students have had their visas revoked, with seven confirmed cases from the University of Chicago and eight confirmed cases from Southern Illinois University Edwardsville. A high-ranking official at U. of I. who did not have permission to speak on the record told the Tribune that 19 students had their visas rescinded, according to data in the SEVIS system, an online system used to monitor the

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AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hopes and hoops

Bulls guard Lonzo Ball holds up his pants leg to show off his left knee before a game against the Heat on Wednesday at the United Center. With him are the family of Alex Reinhardt, the donor for Ball's cartilage transplant surgery. Ball returned to the court this season after sitting out 2 1/2 seasons after the initial knee injury on Jan. 14, 2022. He underwent three procedures in that time, including the cartilage transplant on March 20, 2023. Reinhardt's family donated his organs after he died in February 2023 at age 20 — giving Ball a shot at a pain-free life and the resumption of his NBA career. **Chicago Sports**

EMIL JONES III TRIAL

Ex-red light camera exec talks cigars, dinners, bribes



Omar Maani, FBI mole and former co-owner of SafeSpeed LLC, leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago after testifying in state Sen. Emil Jones III's trial on Thursday. **CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE**

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Burr Ridge businessman Omar Maani told a federal jury Thursday that he started bribing public officials when he was still in his 20s, making money hand-over-fist as a real estate developer and co-founder of lucrative red light camera company SafeSpeed LLC.

To Maani, it was the necessary way to do business in Illinois. He testified he once gave \$23,000 in cash to a clout-heavy lawyer to pass to Cicero Town President Larry Dominick as a show of appreciation. He used his mother's account to cut a check to Crestwood Mayor Louis Presta to help get cameras in the suburb, he said. He paid off then-McCook Mayor and Cook County Commissioner Jeffrey Tobolski to keep his development contracts there.

And Maani repeatedly handed

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'Breakfast Club' with Gen-Z

This weekend, C2E2 in Chicago has the first all-cast "Breakfast Club" reunion in 40 years. We asked some students at Glenbrook North, the school depicted in John Hughes' movie, to watch it for the first time. So much in the film wouldn't fly today, they said, but one big part remains spot-on. **A+E**



From backer to critic

Once in favor of Fire land deal, housing authority resident leader now says CHA "sabotaging" redevelopment. **Business**

